

Daniyaal's Childhood - A Visual Narrative

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A keepsake quilt made mostly of Daniyaal's baby clothes, with a few of his parents' clothes.

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Size: 54" x 75" (approximately)
Time taken: approximately 2.5 months.

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Little Daniyaal is all grown up now - turning 22 years old and about to graduate from university.

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Endless gratitude to Daniyaal's parents for giving me complete freedom to design with no time constraints. Above all for sharing those precious memories depicted on this quilt. I have had so much fun working on this project.

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The reverse side of the quilt has all his mother's outfits that she wore while expecting Daniyaal; along with the reverse side of Garfield (placed right behind its front image; and all the sweet little pockets from his baby clothes. These pockets are all usable, and little notes can be put into them!

Stories of Daniyaal depicted on this quilt:

Born on the 25th of September 2004, Daniyaal is the eldest of three siblings

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A mother's dream baby, who slept really well - 3 hours in the afternoon and 12 hours in the night.

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In his mother's words, "Daniyaal loved King Kong (the first full movie that he probably watched) – possibly because it also contained his favourite dinosaurs. The obsession with rewatching lasted a long time, and through this phase, Daniyaal liked to re-enact the King Kong vs Dinosaur fight scene with his father".

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The tree on this panel is made from Daniyaal's overalls. The foliage of the trees is made from his little baby onesie that had the camouflage print. The green leaves, the red flowers, and the yellow grass are from his mother's clothes

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Was a boy scout for a few years in middle school. Took part in Scouts Jamboree in Nova Scotia. Also had many funny (often exaggerated 😊) stories from his various camps. One of them is depicted on this quilt - in his mother's words: "having to sleep in the tent during winter survival camp, and waking up with his feet sticking in a pool of water (melted ice) - while miraculously not getting any visible frost bite to validate this story".

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Loved drawing dinosaurs and dragons.

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Crazy about gaming. Daniyaal has maintained friendships through gaming (Call of Duty specifically), despite numerous relocations in the last decade.

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Used to love 'The Incredibles' (that he referred to as "tedibles") and for a while called his father "Bob" instead of "Baba", since that was Mr Incredible's name.

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Discovered basketball, during covid, and it really helped Daniyaal deal with the severe lockdowns in Manila. For him, sports has often been the best way for meeting new people and making friends. Basketball has also helped him connect with others at university.

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During the years the family was in Saudi, little Daniyaal enjoyed playing in the compound with his friends - riding bikes, playing soccer and eating Burger King together.

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A thrill-seeker. Enjoyed zip-lining, roller coasters, high speed/elevation rides - "a surprise for an otherwise very prudent/risk-averse child".

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Loved Messi. Lived and breathed soccer. Had deep analytical knowledge about both the game and the players. At one time wanted to grow up and be a professional soccer coach.

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In his mother's words: "Super analytical. Would refuse to pick up a book to read but would devour the news since he was 9 years old (downloaded a BBC news app on his ipad), and most of the time seemed to know more about the world around him than most adults in his life did."

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Daniyaal started talking when he was 11 months old. Some phrases/words that his mother remembers from his younger years are: 'Apoo Pie' (Apple pie), 'Two Toffies' (request from grandparents every time they stepped out), and 'Epic'

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Had a long-lasting nutella love, from childhood to teenagers, but it did not last beyond that

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Little Daniyaal had two strong obsessions: Trucks - could name different kinds, by the time he was 2; and Dinosaurs - aged 4 - had lots of dinosaur toys and books